

MY BUDDY AAC COMPLETE TRAINING KIT

Complete Training Kit

A binder-ready guide for setup, teaching, daily practice, low-tech backup, and real-life communication routines.

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MY BUDDY AAC COMPLETE TRAINING KIT

How to Use This Binder

Start small, use the board during real life, and return to the sections you need.

1. Prepare

Complete the device and offline checklist in Section 1.

2. Learn the layout

Use the exact board map and color key in Section 2.

3. Train partners

Share the short partner guide with family, school, and care teams.

4. Practice

Choose one seven-day activity or one routine that is already happening.

5. Keep a backup

Print both low-tech boards and store them with the device.

6. Record needs

Write down vocabulary that should be added or practiced.

MY BUDDY AAC BINDER DIVIDER

Section 1

Caregiver Getting Started

Device setup, offline checks, personalization, and first-session support.

Caregiver Getting Started Guide

Set up a dependable communication system, teach it without pressure, and keep it ready offline.

No account

No ads

No cloud profile

Works offline after loading

Give the communicator time, attention, and enough vocabulary to be heard, believed, and able to say something new.

1. Set up the device

- [] Open My Buddy while connected to the internet and wait for "Saved for offline use."
- [] Add the page to the Home Screen if the browser offers that option.
- [] Open it once more while online after an update, then test it in airplane mode.
- [] Keep another communication method available for emergencies and device failure.

2. Personalize safety information

Use Menu and enter only the information that is useful on this device. It stays in this browser on this device; it is not sent to a QNS account or server.

- [] Name
- [] Phone number
- [] Address, city, and state
- [] School
- [] Emergency information that should be spoken

3. Know the three main areas

- Sentence strip: selected words collect at the top. Delete removes one; Clear removes all; Speak reads the whole message.
- Core board: high-use words stay in fixed positions so the movement can become familiar.
- Right-side tools: Quick speaks saved urgent phrases; Find teaches a route; Menu contains setup and editing; History repeats recent words; Simple View makes targets larger.

How to support communication

Model, wait, and respond

- Model on the board while you speak. The communicator does not have to copy you.
- Use one more word than the person currently uses: model “want drink” after a one-word message.
- Pause long enough for the person to plan and move. Silence is processing time.
- Honor clear messages, especially no, stop, hurt, help, and bathroom-related messages.
- Treat unexpected combinations as possible communication before correcting grammar.

Avoid testing: “Show me ____” turns communication into a quiz. Instead, use the word naturally and let the person see where it is.

A 10-minute first session

Minute	What to do
0-2	Choose a motivating activity and keep the board within reach.
2-5	Model 3-5 useful words: want, more, help, stop, go.
5-8	Build one sentence without requiring imitation.
8-10	Let the communicator explore; respond to meaningful taps.

Editing and backups

- Use Edit board to add personally meaningful words inside the page where they belong.
- Use Back up words and settings after personalization and before changing devices.
- Photos, custom words, and personal information are stored locally and can disappear if browser data is erased.

Before relying on it away from Wi-Fi

- ☐ Airplane-mode test passed
- ☐ Speech volume is audible
- ☐ Charging plan is ready
- ☐ Backup file is stored safely
- ☐ A second way to communicate is available

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Section 2

Core Board Teaching Guide

Exact board map, color key, motor planning, Find, and modeling routes.

Core Board Teaching Guide

A visual map of the exact 12 x 7 Full View board, its color system, and repeatable paths for teaching language.

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I	we	want	like	go	help	is	on	in	up	feel	here
you	they	play	eat	drink	look	come	give	do	can	talk	again
he	she	make	get	put	open	turn	read	sit	walk	run	down
it	sleep	need	that	love	happy	not	out	off	sad	and	the
yes	more	good	big	hot	some	all done	little	bad	no	stop	cold
my	please	thank you	sorry	what	where	who	when	why	how	to	grammar
CLEAR	food	people	feelings	places	animals	things	colors	body	clothes	my words	ABC

A Level 1 word repeats in the same physical location when its related word page opens. Repeating that path helps the movement become familiar.

Why the board is organized this way

- Rows 1-4 hold pronouns, actions, grammar, and descriptions used across many situations.
- Row 5 adds responses and describing words.
- Row 6 holds social words, question words, to, and the grammar doorway.
- Row 7 contains category doorways. The category is a path to vocabulary, not a spoken sentence.

Color key

	Pronouns	I, you, he, she, we, they
	Actions	want, go, make, help, feel
	Descriptions	happy, big, hot, little
	People & things	school, food, people, objects
	Social words	yes, no, please, stop, sorry
	Grammar	to, the, and, in, where, why
	Folders	food, people, places, body, ABC

Teach color as a clue, never as the answer

Say “actions are green, so look in the green area” while still naming and modeling the word. A communicator may use location, color, picture, print, or all four.

Useful Level 1 paths

Goal	Model	Why it matters
Request	I want more	Pronoun + action + description
Go somewhere	I want to go to school	Includes the grammar word to
Reject	I do not want that	A complete refusal
Ask	where is my phone	Question + grammar + possession
Comment	I like that	Communication beyond requesting
Health	I feel sick and need help	Describes and requests support
Repair	not that, I want this	Corrects a misunderstanding

Modeling routes

Do not move words to make them easier. Repeat the same route until it becomes familiar.

Message	Route to model
go to school	Home: go -> Home: to -> Home: school / Places: school
I need bathroom	Home: I -> Home: need -> Places/Body vocabulary: bathroom
open the door	Home: open -> Home: the -> Things: door
my tummy hurts	Home: my -> Body: tummy -> Health/Body: hurt
what happened	Home: what -> action page: happened
I want a different game	Home: I -> want -> Grammar: a -> Descriptions: different -> Things: game

Use Find as a teaching tool

- Type a word and choose a result. The app highlights each press from Home in order.
- Watch the path, then return Home and model the same path yourself.
- If no exact word appears, add a useful personal word to the most meaningful folder.

Simple View

Simple View uses a 6 x 8 layout with larger targets for phones and smaller screens. It is a complete communication view, and repeated words keep stable Simple View positions.

Incomplete, unconventional, and multimodal messages still carry meaning. Respond to the message the communicator is trying to share.

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Section 3

Communication Partner Guide

Access, modeling, wait time, dignity, privacy, and message repair.

Communication Partner Guide

A short training for family, school staff, respite providers, medical teams, and community partners.

No account

No ads

No cloud profile

Works offline after loading

Presume competence. The device is the person's voice, not a reward, lesson, or behavior-control tool.

The six partner habits

1	Keep access The board stays within reach, charged, and available across settings.
2	Model Tap a few words while you speak naturally. No copying is required.
3	Wait Pause after a model or question. Do not rush to fill the silence.
4	Respond Treat a meaningful tap or combination as communication.
5	Confirm If uncertain, reflect the message: "You said stop. Do you want this to stop?"
6	Repair together Offer Find, yes/no, gestures, writing, or choices without taking over the message.

Say this / avoid this

Supportive	Avoid
"I'm listening."	"Use your words."
"Take your time."	Repeated prompts or countdowns
"You said no. I hear you."	Ignoring no or stop
Modeling "I want music"	"Find want. Now find music."
"I'm not sure. Show me another way."	Guessing and moving on

Safety, privacy, and dignity

- ☐ Never remove access as a consequence.
- ☐ Do not read private saved information aloud unless the communicator requests it or safety requires it.
- ☐ Honor stop, no, pain, bathroom, and help immediately enough to establish trust.
- ☐ Do not photograph, post, or share a person's communication without permission.
- ☐ Keep a low-tech backup available when charging, updating, or repairing the device.

Partner practice

Practice these before supporting the communicator in a high-pressure moment.

- ☐ Find and model: I want to go home
- ☐ Find and model: I do not like that
- ☐ Find and model: where is my phone
- ☐ Use Find to locate an unfamiliar word
- ☐ Switch between Full and Simple View
- ☐ Speak a Quick phrase
- ☐ Locate My Info without changing it

Team agreement

We will keep the system available, model without demanding, wait for communication, honor clear refusals, and report vocabulary needs to the person's primary support team.

Partner name	Role	Date

If the board does not speak, remain calm. Preserve the person's message using pointing, writing, gestures, or a backup board while the device is checked.

MY BUDDY AAC BINDER DIVIDER

Section 4

Seven-Day Practice Pack

One week of short communication activities and reflection pages.

Daily Practice Pack

Seven short printable activities for learning the exact My Buddy AAC board through ordinary communication.

No account

No ads

No cloud profile

Works offline after loading

Model each activity first. Participation can be watching, pointing, tapping, speaking, signing, or choosing not to continue.

Weekly plan

Day	Focus	Model
1	Requests	I want more
2	Actions	we go / you help / I make
3	Comments	I like that / it is good
4	Refusal	no / stop / I do not want that
5	Questions	where is my ____ / what is that
6	Feelings & health	I feel ____ / I need help
7	Conversation	Mix comments, questions, and repair

Day 1 - Request without quizzing

[] Place two enjoyable items in view.

[] Model "I want" plus one item.

[] Wait. Accept any clear selection or refusal.

[] Model "more" or "all done" when it naturally fits.

MODEL	I want more	I want that	all done
-------	-------------	-------------	----------

What the communicator chose to say:

Vocabulary we should add or practice:

Day 2 - Action hunt

[] During real activities, model one green action word.

[] Use go, help, make, open, put, or play.

[] Repeat the same location instead of moving the word.

MODEL	we go	you help	I make it
-------	-------	----------	-----------

What the communicator chose to say:

Vocabulary we should add or practice:

Day 3 - Comment, do not only request

[] Notice something interesting together.

[] Model like, good, bad, funny, hot, or cold.

[] Respond to the comment instead of asking a question.

MODEL	I like that	it is good	that is funny
-------	-------------	------------	---------------

What the communicator chose to say:

Vocabulary we should add or practice:

Day 4 - Powerful refusal

[] Create safe opportunities to decline.

[] Model no, stop, not, and all done.

[] Honor the message so the words remain trustworthy.

MODEL	no	stop that	I do not want that
-------	----	-----------	--------------------

What the communicator chose to say:

Vocabulary we should add or practice:

Day 5 - Ask a real question

[] Hide or misplace a familiar item.

[] Model where + is + my + item.

[] Use Find if the item word is unfamiliar.

MODEL	where is my phone	what is that	who is there
-------	-------------------	--------------	--------------

What the communicator chose to say:

Vocabulary we should add or practice:

Day 6 - Feelings and help

[] Model a true feeling or body state.

[] Pair feel with a description.

[] Show how and when to ask for help.

MODEL	I feel tired	I feel sick	I need help
-------	--------------	-------------	-------------

What the communicator chose to say:

Vocabulary we should add or practice:

Day 7 - Conversation and repair

[] Make a comment, then wait for a response.

[] If misunderstood, model not that or different.

[] Let the communicator change or abandon the message.

MODEL	not that	I want different	I mean this
-------	----------	------------------	-------------

What the communicator chose to say:

Vocabulary we should add or practice:

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Section 5

Low-Tech Backup Boards

Printable Full View and Simple View boards for outages and travel.

MY BUDDY AAC PRINTABLE

Full View Backup Board

Print in color and keep it with the device. The cell order matches the English 12 x 7 Full View board.

MESSAGE											
I	we	want	like	go	help	is	on	in	up	feel	here
you	they	play	eat	drink	look	come	give	do	can	talk	again
he	she	make	get	put	open	turn	read	sit	walk	run	down
it	sleep	need	that	love	happy	not	out	off	sad	and	the
yes	more	good	big	hot	some	all done	little	bad	no	stop	cold
my	please	thank you	sorry	what	where	who	when	why	how	to	grammar
CLEAR	food	people	feelings	places	animals	things	colors	body	clothes	my words	ABC

Point to words in order. A partner can repeat the message aloud and write it in the strip. Gray cells open a vocabulary group on the app.

Simple View Backup Board

Larger targets for phones, small screens, travel, and times when a reduced display is easier to access.

MESSAG
E

 I	 you	 want	 need	 help	 stop
 yes	 no	 more	 all done	 please	 sorry
 go	 come	 eat	 drink	to	 bathroom
 happy	 sad	 angry	 scared	 tired	 hurt
 not	 that	 in	 out	 what	 where
 my	 people	 food	 feelings	 places	 body
 home	 school	 things	 clothes	 animals	 ABC
 can	 do	 like	 play	 look	 read

Keep this board available during charging, updates, travel, and device problems. Continue to honor pointing, gestures, signs, speech, and writing.

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Section 6

Everyday Routine Teaching Boards

Sixteen real-life routines with messages and exact board paths.

MY BUDDY AAC PRINTABLE

Everyday Routine Teaching Boards

Sixteen activity pages for modeling the exact My Buddy word paths during real life.

Choose one routine that is already happening. Model one useful message, pause, and respond to whatever the communicator does next. Pointing, tapping, speech, signs, gestures, and looking toward a choice can all carry meaning.

	Pronouns	I, you, he, she, we, they
	Actions	want, go, make, help, feel
	Descriptions	happy, big, hot, little
	People & things	school, food, people, objects
	Social words	yes, no, please, stop, sorry
	Grammar	to, the, and, in, where, why
	Folders	food, people, places, body, ABC

Included routines

1	Bathroom	2	Wash hands
3	Get dressed	4	Bedtime
5	Morning	6	Breakfast
7	Make food	8	Leave home
9	Go to school	10	In class
11	Playground	12	Living room
13	Health and pain	14	Store and community
15	Big feelings	16	Fix a misunderstanding

MY BUDDY AAC PRINTABLE

Bathroom

Keep the board within reach before urgency starts.

Model these paths

I	need	bathroom
---	------	----------

Home I -> I | Home need -> need | Home Places -> bathroom

I	need	to	pee
---	------	----	-----

Home I -> I | Home need -> need | Home to | Home Body -> pee

I	need	to	poop
---	------	----	------

Home I -> I | Home need -> need | Home to | Home Body -> poop

help	me	please
------	----	--------

Home help -> help | Home I -> me | Home please

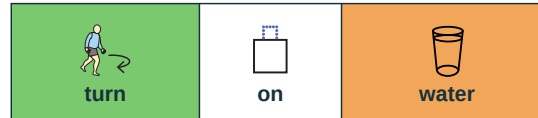
Words the communicator wanted during this routine:

MY BUDDY AAC PRINTABLE

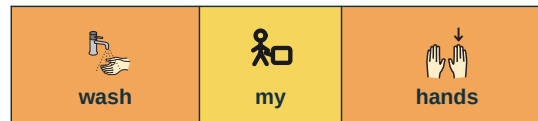
Wash hands

Model the words during the real sequence at the sink.

Model these paths



Home turn -> turn | Home on | Home Food -> water



Use Find for wash | Home my | Home Body -> hands



Home help -> help | Home I -> me | Use Find for wash



Home turn -> turn | Home off | Home Food -> water

Words the communicator wanted during this routine:

Get dressed

Offer choices and leave time for refusal or a request for help.

Model these paths

 I	 need	 shirt
--	--	--

Home I -> I | Home need -> need | Home Clothes -> shirt

 put	 on	 pants
--	---	--

Home put -> put | Home on | Home Clothes -> pants

 where	 are	 my	 shoes
--	--	---	--

Home where | Home Grammar -> are | Home my | Home Clothes -> shoes

 I	 need	 help
---	--	--

Home I -> I | Home need -> need | Home help -> help

Words the communicator wanted during this routine:

Bedtime

Use these words as choices and comments during the routine.

Model these paths

I	feel	tired
---	------	-------

Home I -> I | Home feel -> feel | Home Feelings -> tired

I	want	my	blanket
---	------	----	---------

Home I -> I | Home want -> want | Home my | Home Things -> blanket

turn	off	light
------	-----	-------

Home turn -> turn | Home off | Home Things -> light

I	need	bathroom
---	------	----------

Home I -> I | Home need -> need | Home Places -> bathroom

Words the communicator wanted during this routine:

Morning

Keep language available from waking through leaving home.

Model these paths

 I	 need	 bathroom
--	--	---

Home I -> I | Home need -> need | Home Places -> bathroom

 put	 on	 clothes
--	--	--

Home put -> put | Home on | Home clothes

 I	 want	 cereal
--	--	---

Home I -> I | Home want -> want | Home Food -> cereal

 I	 am	 ready
---	---	---

Home I -> I | Home Grammar -> am | Use Find for ready

Words the communicator wanted during this routine:

Breakfast

Pause naturally so there is room to request, comment, or finish.

Model these paths

I	want	cereal
---	------	--------

Home I -> I | Home want -> want | Home Food -> cereal

I	want	milk
---	------	------

Home I -> I | Home want -> want | Home Food -> milk

more	please
------	--------

Home more | Home please

all done

Home all done

Words the communicator wanted during this routine:

Make food

Model action words while preparing a real snack or meal.

Model these paths

I	want	to	make	food
---	------	----	------	------

Home I -> I | Home want -> want | Home to | Home make -> make | Home food

put	it	in
-----	----	----

Home put -> put | Home it -> it | Home in

help	me	open	it
------	----	------	----

Home help -> help | Home I -> me | Home open -> open | Home it -> it

it	is	hot
----	----	-----

Home it -> it | Home is | Home hot

Words the communicator wanted during this routine:

Leave home

Post this near the door and model it during the actual routine.

Model these paths

 put	 on	 shoes
--	--	--

Home put -> put | Home on | Home Clothes -> shoes

 I	 need	 my	 jacket
--	---	---	---

Home I -> I | Home need -> need | Home my | Home Clothes -> jacket

 go	 to	 car
---	---	--

Home go -> go | Home to | Use Find for car

 I	 am	 ready
---	---	---

Home I -> I | Home Grammar -> am | Use Find for ready

Words the communicator wanted during this routine:

Go to school

Practice the route during calm moments and use it again on school days.

Model these paths

I	want	to	go	to	school
---	------	----	----	----	--------

Home I -> I | Home want -> want | Home to | Home go -> go | Home to | Home Places -> school

where	=	my	teacher
-------	---	----	---------

Home where | Home is | Home my | Home People -> teacher

I	need	a	break
---	------	---	-------

Home I -> I | Home need -> need | Use Find for a | Home School words -> break

I	need	help
---	------	------

Home I -> I | Home need -> need | Home help -> help

Words the communicator wanted during this routine:

In class

Make room for questions, help, breaks, and finishing.

Model these paths

I	 want	 my	 book
---	--	--	--

Home I -> I | Home want -> want | Home my | Home School words -> book

I	 need	paper
---	---	-------

Home I -> I | Home need -> need | Home School words -> paper

 can	 you	 help
---	---	--

Home can | Home you -> you | Home help -> help

I	am	 all done
---	----	---

Home I -> I | Home Grammar -> am | Home all done

Words the communicator wanted during this routine:

Playground

Use the board for joining, directing, stopping, and leaving.

Model these paths

 I	 want	to	 play
--	---	----	---

Home I -> I | Home want -> want | Home to | Home play -> play

 go	 outside
---	--

Home go -> go | Home Places -> outside

 I	 want	 ball
--	--	---

Home I -> I | Home want -> want | Home Things -> ball

 stop	 please
--	--

Home stop | Home please

Words the communicator wanted during this routine:

Living room

Model control of shared activities such as television and music.

Model these paths

I	want	to	watch	TV
---	------	----	-------	----

Home I -> I | Home want -> want | Home to | Use Find for watch | Home TV and media -> TV

turn	it	on
------	----	----

Home turn -> turn | Home it -> it | Home on

turn	it	up
------	----	----

Home turn -> turn | Home it -> it | Home up

turn	it	off
------	----	-----

Home turn -> turn | Home it -> it | Home off

Words the communicator wanted during this routine:

Health and pain

Respond promptly to health messages and confirm the body area.

Model these paths

 I	 feel	 sick
--	---	---

Home I -> I | Home feel -> feel | Home Feelings -> sick

 my	tummy	hurts
---	-------	-------

Home my | Home Body -> tummy | Use Find for hurts

 I	 need	medicine
--	--	----------

Home I -> I | Home need -> need | Home Body -> medicine

 I	 want	 doctor
---	---	--

Home I -> I | Home want -> want | Use Find for doctor

Words the communicator wanted during this routine:

Store and community

Use comments and choices during real trips.

Model these paths

I	want	to	go	to	store
---	------	----	----	----	-------

Home I -> I | Home want -> want | Home to | Home go -> go | Home to | Home Places -> store

I	want	that
---	------	------

Home I -> I | Home want -> want | Home that

H?	much	money
----	------	-------

Home how | Use Find for much | Home Things -> money

all done

Home all done

Words the communicator wanted during this routine:

Big feelings

Keep demands low and allow the communicator to use any reliable method.

Model these paths

I I	feel heart icon	angry angry face icon
--------	--------------------	--------------------------

Home I -> I | Home feel -> feel | Home Feelings -> angry

I I	need hand icon	a	break two people fighting icon
--------	-------------------	---	-----------------------------------

Home I -> I | Home need -> need | Use Find for a | Home School words -> break

I I	want hands holding a square icon	quiet
--------	-------------------------------------	-------

Home I -> I | Home want -> want | Home describing word page -> quiet

help hands icon	me	calm person sitting icon
--------------------	----	-----------------------------

Home help -> help | Home I -> me | Home Feelings -> calm

Words the communicator wanted during this routine:

Fix a misunderstanding

Pause and give the communicator time to change the message.

Model these paths

 no	 not	 that
---	--	---

Home no | Home not | Home that

 I	 mean	 different
--	--	--

Home I -> I | Use Find for mean | Home Grammar -> different

 I	 want	 this
--	--	----------

Home I -> I | Home want -> want | Home Grammar -> this

 please	 wait
--	----------

Home please | Use Find for wait

Words the communicator wanted during this routine:

MY BUDDY AAC COMPLETE TRAINING KIT

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